

Matthew Franks

Cybersecurity Product Support and Escalation Engineering Leader

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Cybersecurity product support leader with 11+ years at Cisco in technical support and escalation engineering, including leadership of a Tier 3 team across XDR, endpoint, cloud security, and malware analysis. Experienced in critical customer escalations, engineer coaching, cross-functional defect resolution, and support workflow improvement. Builds diagnostic and reporting tools that make complex investigations simple, repeatable, and accessible to everyone.

CORE STRENGTHS

Technical support team leadership | Critical escalation management | Engineer coaching and training | Support process improvement | Case triage and operational reporting | Root-cause analysis and defect reproduction | Enterprise security troubleshooting | Python and API automation | Product and Engineering partnership

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Technical Leader, Escalations

May 2026–Present; Nov 2024–Oct 2025

Cisco | Remote

- Lead complex XDR and Secure Endpoint escalations, coordinating technical discussions with customers, frontline TAC, and Engineering.
- Reproduce defects, turn customer evidence into actionable findings, and author customer-facing API and diagnostic guidance.
- Build Python- and API-driven workflows for case triage, reporting, and operational visibility; mentor escalation engineers through difficult investigations.

Leader, Software Engineering

Nov 2025–May 2026

Cisco | Remote

- Led a team of escalation engineers delivering Tier 3 support across Cisco Security Cloud Control, XDR, Secure Endpoint, Orbital, Endpoint Visibility Module, and Secure Malware Analytics.
- Coordinated complex customer escalations across frontline TAC and Engineering to isolate issues, create complex reproductions, validate defects, and drive resolution.
- Coached engineers on technical investigations and customer communication while promoting consistent case handling, knowledge sharing, and accountability.

Software (Escalation) Engineer IV

Jul 2022–Nov 2024

Cisco | Remote

- Resolved complex multi-product security issues and analyzed customer case patterns to inform product features and design decisions.
- Partnered with Development, Test, Documentation, and Product Management on design issues and assessed deployments to recommend supportable solutions.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE CONTINUED

Software (Escalation) Engineer III | Software QA Engineer

Nov 2018–Jul 2022

Cisco | Raleigh-Durham, NC / Remote

- Served as a subject-matter expert across Secure Endpoint, network, cloud, web, email, malware analysis, and threat-intelligence products.
- Recreated customer issues in a lab, verified defects, and developed tests and frameworks for Advanced Threat features and integrations during a concurrent QA assignment (Sep 2020–Jul 2022).

Customer Support Engineer

Jan 2015–Nov 2018

Cisco | Raleigh-Durham-Chapel Hill, NC

- Supported enterprise Sourcefire/FirePOWER and AMP deployments, including Firepower IDS/IPS integrated with Cisco ASA firewalls.
- Used packet captures, logs, and platform diagnostics to isolate network and security issues and partnered with Development to verify defects.

MILITARY LEADERSHIP

Cyber Operations Technician, U.S. Army Chief Warrant Officer III

May 2002–Jul 2022 (Retired)

United States Army National Guard | Fairfax, VA

- Led Cyber Operations/Signals Intelligence section. Responsible for coordinating training, language qualifications, and occupational certifications.
- Advised Command on cyberspace operations and the integration, operation, and management of cyber assets.
- Trained, mentored, and evaluated cyber personnel; developed technical SOPs, policies, and qualification standards.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

B.S., Business Administration and Management | Fayetteville State University | Magna Cum Laude

A.A., Modern Standard Arabic | Defense Language Institute Foreign Language Center | Top 10%

Splunk Core Certified User (2026–2029)

Cisco Certified DevNet Specialist, Security Automation and Programmability (active until 2028)

CCNA Automation (active until 2028)